

Mind the Gael

Business Plan · June 2026 · Prepared by Emily Phelan, Founder

1. Executive Summary

Mind the Gael is an AI powered mental performance and physical training platform built specifically for female Gaelic footballers. The platform combines a library of evidence based mental performance tools (the Gael Performance Toolkit) with AI generated, personalised Mental Performance Plans and physical training plans, delivered through a modern web platform built on the Anthropic Claude API.

Ladies Gaelic football is one of the fastest growing female sports in Europe, with the LGFA reporting almost 200,000 members across roughly 1,000 clubs in Ireland and Britain. Yet sport psychology and structured strength and conditioning remain concentrated at county level. The ordinary club player, the vast majority of the playing population, has no affordable access to either. Mind the Gael closes that gap at a price point any club player can afford.

The platform is currently in beta. The next milestone is an eight week pilot with 15 players across four clubs, supervised by a sports psychologist, a strength and conditioning coach, and two to three personal trainers including the founder. The pilot will produce expert endorsements, named testimonials, and case studies that underpin a credible public launch.

The business model combines low friction one off plan purchases with a content subscription: a £5 per month subscriber blog, £10 for a 6 week plan and £20 for a 12 week plan, priced identically across mental performance and physical training. Phase 2 rolls the platform out to club memberships. The plan targets sustainable, founder led growth funded from revenue, with modest startup costs because the founder builds the product herself.

Ladies Gaelic football is the proving ground, not the ceiling. The platform is built as a sport agnostic engine, expert reviewed content turned into AI personalised plans for a specific sporting community, with Gaelic football as the first community. Once the model is proven against defined gate criteria, the same playbook extends to camogie and then to other women's sports, each a new market with the playbook already written.

Mission

To give every female Gaelic footballer access to the mental performance and physical training support that has, until now, been reserved for county panels.

2. The Problem

- **Mental performance support is rationed.** Sport psychology in Gaelic games is concentrated in county setups. Club players dealing with match day nerves, confidence dips, or focus problems have nowhere structured to turn.
- **Generic fitness apps do not fit the sport.** Mainstream training apps are not built for the demands of Gaelic football: the mix of sprinting, kicking, contact, and the club training calendar. None are built for women in the sport.
- **The female player is underserved.** Training and psychology content is overwhelmingly written for male athletes. Female players face distinct needs across physiology, injury risk profiles, and the realities of balancing sport with work and life.
- **One to one support does not scale or suit budgets.** A sport psychologist costs far more per session than a club player will spend in a year. Clubs cannot fund it either.

Who feels this problem

The primary user is the adult female club player, aged 19 to 40, playing junior to senior club football in Ireland or Britain. She trains two to three times a week, plays matches through the summer, cares about performing, and has disposable income for sport at the price of a streaming subscription but not at the price of private coaching.

3. The Solution and Product

Mind the Gael is a web platform with three connected layers. Mental performance is the primary differentiator; physical training plans are a complementary product.

Layer	What it is	Status
Gael Performance Toolkit	A standalone library of evidence based mental performance tools, each documented and usable on its own. The first document, GPT-001, covers attention control in the pre match context.	In build, library growing
Mental Performance Plan	An AI generated, personalised selection and sequencing of toolkit resources, matched to the player's stated challenges, position, and schedule. Built on the Anthropic Claude API.	Beta
Physical training plans	AI generated training programmes built around the Gaelic football season and the club training week, kept deliberately separate from the mental performance product.	Beta
Blog and content	Credibility building content on mental performance and training for female Gaelic footballers, doubling as the top of the marketing funnel.	Live

Why this product wins

- **Specificity.** Built for one sport, one gender, one community. Generic competitors cannot match the relevance, and the niche is too small for big platforms to chase.
- **AI economics.** Personalised plans at near zero marginal cost make individualised support viable at a club player's price point for the first time.

- **Expert reviewed, AI delivered.** Toolkit content is reviewed by qualified professionals; the AI personalises and sequences it. The platform never positions itself as therapy or medical advice.
- **Community roots.** Founder led, built from inside the GAA community, launched through founding clubs rather than paid acquisition.

4. Market Analysis

The LGFA reports almost 200,000 members across roughly 1,000 clubs in Ireland and Britain, and describes ladies Gaelic football as one of the fastest growing female sports in Europe. Membership grew from around 80,000 in 2001 to over 190,000 by 2020, and the club count has more than doubled over the same period. There is also a growing international scene across Europe, North America, and Australasia.

LGFA membership skews young, with under 16s the largest cohort. The addressable market for Mind the Gael is the adult playing population, estimated below deliberately conservatively.

Tier	Definition	Estimate
TAM	Adult female Gaelic footballers in Ireland and Britain (estimated 30 to 40 percent of total membership)	60,000 to 80,000 players
SAM	Adult club players aged 19 to 40 who train regularly and would pay for performance support	25,000 to 40,000 players
SOM (3 years)	Realistic share reachable through founding clubs, community channels, and content, at 3 to 5 percent of SAM	1,000 to 2,000 subscribers

Adjacent expansion markets, not in the core plan but available later: camogie (a separate association with a large membership of its own), international LGFA clubs, and male Gaelic footballers.

Market tailwinds

- Record visibility for women's Gaelic games: televised championships, growing attendances, and the LGFA's integration into the wider GAA structure
- Normalisation of mental performance work in sport, led by high profile athletes speaking openly about it
- Players already accustomed to paying for fitness apps and subscriptions

Competition

Competitor type	Examples	Why Mind the Gael differs
Generic fitness apps	Mainstream training and workout apps	No Gaelic football specificity, no mental performance depth, not built for female players
Mental wellness apps	Meditation and mindfulness apps	General wellbeing, not sport performance, no connection to the player's actual season and matches
GAA focused S&C programmes	Online GAA strength and conditioning coaches and programmes	Mostly male focused, physical only, no mental performance product, often priced above the club player
One to one professionals	Sport psychologists, personal trainers	Excellent but expensive and scarce. Mind the Gael is complementary at a fraction of the cost

The defensible position is the intersection: female, Gaelic football, mental performance first, expert reviewed, at a club player's price. No current competitor occupies it.

5. Business Model and Pricing

The model combines one off plan purchases with a content subscription. Plans are bought per training block rather than as an open ended subscription, which matches how players actually think about a season (pre season block, championship block) and keeps the buying decision small. Pricing is identical across the mental performance and physical training product lines.

Product	Price	Notes
Subscriber blog	£5 / month	Members only content for female Gaelic footballers. Recurring revenue base and the warm audience for plan sales
Mental Performance Plan, 6 weeks	£10 one off	AI generated, personalised sequence of Gael Performance Toolkit resources
Mental Performance Plan, 12 weeks	£20 one off	Full season or pre season to championship block
Physical training plan, 6 weeks	£10 one off	AI generated programme built around the club training week
Physical training plan, 12 weeks	£20 one off	Same structure and pricing as the mental performance line
Club membership (Phase 2)	Indicative, to be priced	Squad wide access sold to clubs; pricing validated with founding clubs before launch

Unit economics (assumptions)

- Anthropic API cost per generated plan is pence, not pounds, giving a gross margin above 90 percent on plan sales
- A player buying one mental and one physical 12 week block spends £40 per season; an engaged blog subscriber adds £60 per year
- The blog subscription is the recurring base and the conversion path: subscribers are the warmest buyers of plans at season milestones (pre season, championship, return from injury)
- One off pricing removes churn risk on plans entirely; revenue seasonality is managed with January pre season and May championship campaigns
- Hosting on Vercel and static architecture on Astro keep infrastructure costs low at this scale

6. Go to Market

Phase 1: Pilot, proof, and individual launch

- Eight week pilot: 15 players, 4 clubs, expert panel of a sports psychologist and an S&C coach, coordinated by 2 to 3 personal trainers including the founder
- Outputs: named expert endorsements, 8 or more named testimonials, 2 to 3 case studies, and a public pilot results page
- Public launch to individual players: £5 subscriber blog plus one off 6 and 12 week plans, carried by the pilot's credibility assets, with the 4 pilot clubs positioned as founding clubs

- Content engine: weekly blog and social content answering real player questions, distributed where players already are (Instagram, TikTok, club WhatsApp groups)

Phase 2: Club membership rollout

- Club membership product giving squad wide access, sold to club committees, starting with the 4 founding clubs
- Pricing validated with founding clubs before wider rollout; positioned against what clubs already spend on equipment and external coaching
- Club by club expansion through county networks in Cork and London GAA communities, where the founder has roots

Phase 3: Community scale

- Partnerships with ladies club committees, county development squads, and respected voices in the women's game
- Seasonal campaign rhythm: January pre season push, May championship push, autumn reflection and goal setting content
- Evaluate adjacent expansion: camogie, international LGFA clubs

7. Expansion Strategy: Beyond LGFA

The scalable asset is not Mind the Gael the brand; it is the engine underneath it: expert reviewed performance content, structured as a toolkit, turned into personalised plans by AI, launched into a sporting community through a pilot and founding clubs. Ladies Gaelic football proves the engine. Expansion replicates it.

Sport agnostic architecture

- Toolkit content, plan generation logic, and sport specific knowledge are kept as separate layers. Core mental performance tools (attention control, confidence, routines) are sport neutral; each sport adds a flavour layer of context, language, and examples
- Generation prompts treat sport, season structure, positions, and competition names as variables rather than hardcoded text
- Result: launching a new sport is a content and community job, not a platform rebuild

The expansion gate

Expansion begins only when the LGFA version has proven the model. Gate criteria, measured over a full season cycle:

- Repeat purchase rate of 40 percent or higher among plan buyers
- Average plan usefulness rating of 4.0 or higher
- Blog subscriber to plan buyer conversion of 25 percent or higher per season
- At least 4 club memberships sold and renewed intent confirmed
- Expert review and AI guardrail process running with a report rate under 1 percent

Sequencing

Wave	Market	Why and how
1	Camogie	Same clubs, same communities, often the same women playing both codes. Acquisition cost near zero, content overlap high. First test of the replication playbook
2	International LGFA and GAA communities	Established clubs across Britain, Europe, North America, and Australasia. Same sport, new geography, English language
3	Other women's team sports	Women's rugby and soccer as candidate markets, each entered with the standard playbook: expert panel, 15 player pilot across founding clubs, credibility assets, then launch

The replication playbook

Each new sport repeats the proven sequence: recruit a sport specific expert panel, build the flavour layer on the existing toolkit, run an eight week pilot with around 15 players across founding clubs, publish the results transparently, and launch with the same pricing structure. The pilot design, legal stack, consent framework, and measurement approach all transfer unchanged.

Brand architecture

Mind the Gael remains the brand for Gaelic games, where the name carries community meaning, and stretches naturally to camogie. Expansion beyond Gaelic games will sit under a neutral platform identity, with Mind the Gael as its first and flagship product. No renaming is needed now; the principle is simply not to bind the Gaelic specific name into structures that are costly to change, such as the company registration and the codebase.

8. Technology and Operations

Component	Choice	Rationale
Frontend	Astro, HTML/CSS	Fast, content friendly, low cost static first architecture
Hosting	Vercel	Zero ops deployment, scales with traffic
Backend / AI	Python, Anthropic Claude API	Plan generation and personalisation; usage tier managed against Anthropic rate limits
Source control	GitHub	Version control and deployment pipeline

Operating principles

- Founder builds and operates the product; no salaried staff in year one
- Expert reviewers engaged on agreed terms per review cycle rather than employed
- AI guardrails: system prompts keep generators within performance coaching, with signposting to support services and an in product report mechanism
- Quality loop: every reported output reviewed within 48 hours, with fixes shipped or logged

9. Legal and Compliance

A full legal checklist exists as a separate working document. The headline positions:

- **18+ platform.** Date of birth gate at signup, eligibility clause in terms, no marketing to underage players. This removes the minors exposure entirely, and the 19 to 40 target market loses nothing
- **Not medical advice.** Disclaimers at the point of use on both generators: AI generated performance coaching, not medical, psychological, or physiotherapy advice, with support service signposting
- **GDPR (UK and EU).** Privacy policy covering generator inputs, Anthropic API processing and international transfer, explicit consent for health related inputs, retention, and user rights
- **AI transparency.** Clear labelling of AI generated output, aligned with EU AI Act transparency obligations phasing in through 2026
- **Anthropic compliance.** Usage within Anthropic's Usage Policy and Commercial Terms for health adjacent consumer products
- Solicitor review of terms, privacy policy, and disclaimers before paid launch

10. Team

Emily Phelan, Founder. Technical Program Manager with six years at Amazon and AWS, most recently in cybersecurity programme management, with a background spanning cloud security operations, penetration testing programme management, and physical security engineering. AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner and GIAC Certified Project Manager. Emily designs, builds, and operates the platform end to end, and brings the programme management discipline to run the pilot, the compliance work, and the launch as a structured programme. From Cork, embedded in the GAA community the product serves.

Expert panel (engaged, not employed). A sports psychologist reviewing all mental performance content, an accredited S&C coach reviewing training outputs, and 2 to 3 personal trainers acting as pilot coordinators. Named expert review is a core trust asset of the brand.

11. Roadmap

Period	Milestones
Q3 2026	Age gate, disclaimers, consent and privacy documents live. Expert panel agreed. Pilot recruitment through 4 clubs. Pilot starts
Q4 2026	Pilot completes. Results page, testimonials, and endorsements published. Toolkit library expanded. Public launch: £5 subscriber blog plus 6 and 12 week plans, with founding member pricing
H1 2027	Pre season campaign in January, championship campaign in May. Content engine running weekly. Solicitor reviewed legal stack for paid scale
H2 2027	Phase 2: club membership rollout starting with the 4 founding clubs, pricing validated with committees. County development squad partnership
2028	1,200+ plans sold and 30 club memberships targeted. Expansion gate assessed against a full season of data; camogie pilot launched if criteria are met. Decide on first hire or contractor support

12. Financial Projections (Illustrative)

All figures are founder assumptions for planning, not forecasts, in pounds sterling. The model assumes plan sales at an average £15 per plan (mix of £10 six week and £20 twelve week blocks across both product lines), blog subscriptions at £5 per month, and club memberships from year two at an indicative £300 per club per year, to be validated with founding clubs.

	Year 1 (to end 2027)	Year 2 (2028)	Year 3 (2029)
Plans sold (avg £15)	400	1,200	2,600
Blog subscribers (avg active)	40	120	250
Club memberships	0	10	30
Plan sales revenue	£6,000	£18,000	£39,000
Blog subscription revenue	£2,400	£7,200	£15,000
Club membership revenue	£0	£3,000	£9,000
Total revenue	£8,400	£28,200	£63,000
API and hosting	£900	£2,500	£5,500
Expert review fees	£2,000	£3,500	£5,000
Legal, insurance, admin	£2,500	£3,500	£4,500
Marketing and content	£1,200	£4,000	£9,000
Total costs	£6,600	£13,500	£24,000
Operating result	£1,800	£14,700	£39,000

Year 1 plan volume of 400 means roughly 250 to 300 buyers, many purchasing both a mental and a physical block. Excludes founder salary: in years 1 and 2 the business runs alongside the founder's employment, with founder compensation beginning as the operating result allows. Startup costs are minimal (legal documents, insurance, pilot incentives, domain and tooling, estimated under £4,000) and founder funded; no external investment is required for this plan.

Key performance indicators

- Plans sold per month, and 6 week to 12 week mix (the £20 block is the margin driver)
- Repeat purchase rate: share of buyers purchasing a second block within the same season (target 40 percent)
- Cross sell rate between mental performance and physical training lines (target 30 percent)
- Blog subscriber count, monthly churn (target under 5 percent), and subscriber to plan buyer conversion (target 25 percent per season)
- Report rate on AI outputs (target under 1 percent)

13. Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
AI output causes harm or embarrassment	Expert review of all toolkit content, guardrailed prompts, point of use disclaimers, in product reporting, 48 hour triage, 18+ policy
Niche proves too small to sustain growth	Conservative SOM, low cost base profitable at small scale, adjacent expansion paths (camogie, international, men's game)
Seasonal revenue concentration	One off plan pricing carries no churn; revenue is campaign driven with January pre season and May championship pushes, while the £5 blog subscription provides a year round recurring base
Founder bandwidth alongside employment	Fixed weekly time blocks, pilot designed with distributed coordinator roles, automation first operations
Regulatory change (EU AI Act, GDPR enforcement)	Transparency by default, minimal data collection, legal checklist maintained, solicitor review before paid scale
Copycat competitors	Community roots, expert endorsements, and founding club relationships are slow to replicate; content library compounds over time
API cost or platform dependency	Margin headroom above 85 percent absorbs price changes; plan generation architecture is portable across model providers if ever required

14. The Ask and Next Steps

This plan requires no external funding. The immediate priorities are:

- Complete the pre launch legal items: age gate, disclaimers, consent forms, privacy notice
- Sign the expert panel and recruit the 15 pilot players through the four clubs
- Run the eight week pilot and capture the trust assets
- Launch publicly with founding member pricing in Q4 2026